

PRACTICE

Growers are implementing this at every scale.



Agroecology plots at Rancho Cacachilas.

Growers like you are cutting inputs and improving soil, and documenting it.

The basic methodology is universal; the application is based upon locally-sourced materials. Whether you tend a rooftop container or a thousand-acre farm, the principle is the same.

Nick Padwick farms in Norfolk, England. Roberto Silva farms in Piura, Peru. Jenn Sirp grows in California.



Find a trained professional near you

Our graduates who complete their certifications to become consultants and lab-technicians are listed in our online directory. Hire an earned title, not a claim.



Watch a case study from your crop or region.

Hear growers explain in their own words how the Soil Food Web Approach changed their operations through reducing inputs, creating better outputs and improving their bottom lines.

sfw.one/brochure-casestudies

Results shown are from individual sites in specific contexts; outcomes vary with climate, crop and management.

ON YOUR FARM

We start with your soil.



Soil samples beside the microscope.

The steps are the same at every scale: look at the biology under a microscope, add what is missing to rebalance the microbial content, then measure again to confirm microbial counts are going in the expected directions.

What we test before we recommend

-  **Diagnostic first.** Every recommendation starts with a biological analysis under a microscope.
-  **Measurable.** We provide a relative count of various microbes present in your soil or compost sample.
-  **Adaptation and retrofitting.** We help you convert your current operations to the Soil Food Web Approach, at any scale.



Testate amoeba, 40x objective. Photograph: Joy Kaluf. A microbial count names what is present in the sample and their relative numbers: bacteria, fungi, protozoa, nematodes and microarthropods.

What healthy soil biology does



**CYCLES
NUTRIENTS**



**CREATES
SOIL
STRUCTURE**



**INHIBITS
WEED
PRESSURE**



**REDUCES
PESTS AND
DISEASE**

The approach is designed to dramatically reduce dependence on chemical inputs.

LEARN

Learn to grow your own soil biology.



A mentor teaching on working land.

Everyone starts with the Foundation Courses. Where you go next depends on whether you want to apply your skills to your own land or help other farmers improve their soils.



Start learning

The Foundation Courses give you the biological literacy to understand what is actually happening in your soil, why it matters, and what you can do about it. They are online, self-paced, take about 150 hours to complete, and are a prerequisite to any Advanced Program.



Go professional

Learn the practical application of the theory you learned in the Foundation Courses through mentor-led Advanced Programs on Soil Microscopy, BioComplete™ Compost Production, and Biological Liquid Amendments and Field Trial.



Learn in person

Accelerator Workshops are immersive, two-week, hands-on intensives where you produce BioComplete™ compost and biological liquid amendments live, hosted with a partner on their land. Gain a year's worth of hands-on experience in one immersive workshop.



Where it leads

Careers in soil biology analysis as SFW Lab-Technicians, and working with farmers and land stewards to implement the Soil Food Web Approach as SFW Consultants.



Apply for a scholarship

Cost shouldn't keep anyone from healing soil. Scholarships prioritize applicants in under-resourced regions.

sfw.one/brochure-scholarship